

Book 1

RHYTHM
STYLE



Part 4

7EVENTH HEAVEN



7EVENTH HEAVEN

If you look at most song books you will see a LOT of chords with the number 7,

i.e. Cmaj7 (C 'major' 7), C7, G7, Dm7 (D 'minor' 7), etc.

It is IMPORTANT to know how to form seventh chords because they help make rhythm piano sound much more interesting.

There are TWO types of seventh chords: **maj7 and 7**

maj7 is pronounced "major 7" (and is also written as M7 or Δ)

7 is pronounced "seven"

These two sevenths – maj7 and 7 – can be added to ALL the basic major and minor chords.

i.e. **C** could become **Cmaj7** or **C7**

F could become **Fmaj7** or **F7**

Dm could become **Dm(maj7)** or **Dm7**

Am could become **Am(maj7)** or **Am7**

Note - You will rarely encounter a 'minor(major7)' chord - with minor chords you will nearly ALWAYS just add the 7 - ie Dm7, Em7, Am7 etc

Let's look at a REALLY EASY way to make
ALL the seventh chords using
just 2 easy formulas!

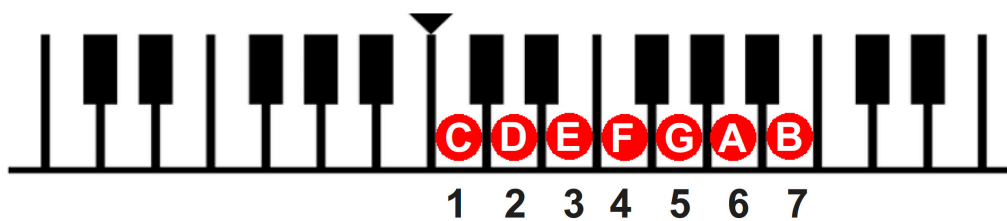
FIRST - WHAT ON EARTH IS A 'SEVENTH' ANYWAY? ¹⁻¹⁷⁹

You don't really need to know the reasoning behind sevenths in order to use them but for all you information junkies out there, here's a simple explanation.

Chords are built on SCALES.

Chord NOTE NUMBERS (ie '1', '3', '5', '7') are derived FROM these scales.

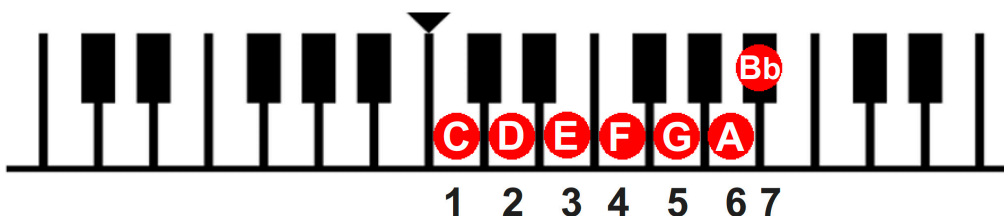
For instance - this is a C MAJOR scale.



The chord of C uses 1 3 5 - C E G

The chord of Cmaj7 uses 1 3 5 **7** - C E G **B**

Below is a C7 scale *



The chord of C7 uses 1 3 5 **7** - C E G **Bb**

** NOTE - in strict theoretical terms this scale would be called C mixolydian but it's just much easier to think of it as a major scale with the 7th note flattened - and call it a 'C7' scale.*

DON'T PANIC!

I have a really EASY way to form sevenths as you'll see on the next page.

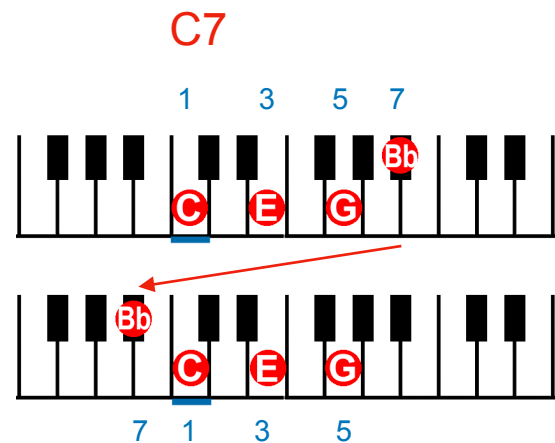
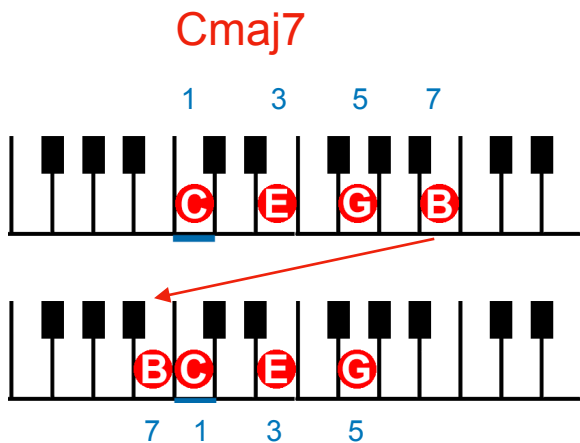
Instead of adding the seventh on TOP of the chord you are going to add it BELOW the chord. This is MUCH easier to do to begin with.

Using the ROOT note to find the 7th

As we have learned - a 7th chord contains the 1st, 3rd, 5th and 7th of a related scale.

We can play the 1st, 3rd, 5th, and 7th in any combination.

So it's ok to play the 7th note BELOW the chord instead of on top.

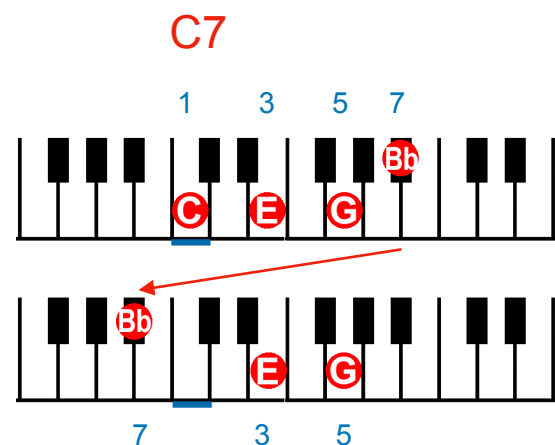
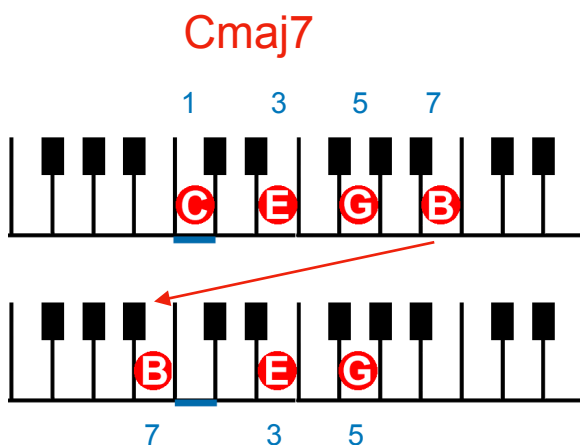


When you do that - notice that the 'maj7' note is just ONE key to the left of the ROOT note of the chord,

And the '7' note is TWO keys left of the root of the chord

And this will hold true for ANY 'maj7' or '7' chord

And because we will be playing the ROOT note of the chord in the LEFT hand we can OMIT the root note from the right hand altogether



Just 2 easy formulas!

maj7
(M7)

To make a M7 chord, play a basic 3 note chord (with your right hand) then move the root note **ONE** key to the left (count the black keys)

7

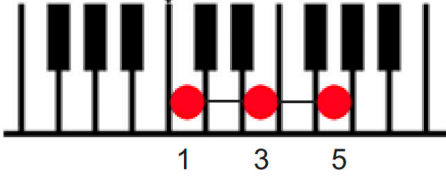
To make a 7 chord, play a basic 3 note chord (with your right hand) then move the root note **TWO** keys to the left (count the black keys).

Note - DON'T alter LEFT HAND notes or patterns

Let's try it on the chord of C

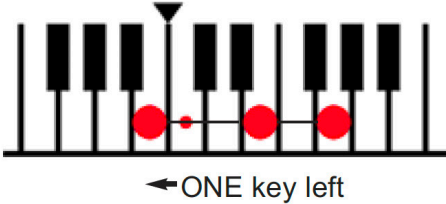
RIGHT HAND

ROOT CHORD



C

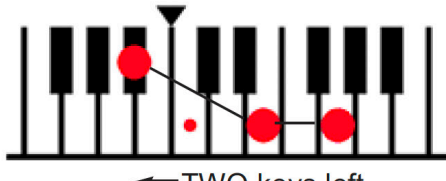
maj7



← ONE key left

Cmaj7

7



← TWO keys left

C7

**The reason you don't need the root note of the chord in the right hand is because you will be playing it in the LEFT HAND*

FORMING MORE SEVENTH CHORDS

(remember the Left hand will play the ROOT note of the chord)

	Dm	Em	F
ROOT 1 KEY LEFT	Dm(maj7)	Em(maj7)	F(maj7)
ROOT 2 KEYS LEFT	Dm7	Em7	F7
	G	Am	Bb
ROOT 1 KEY LEFT	G(maj7)	Am(maj7)	Bb(maj7)
ROOT 2 KEYS LEFT	G7	Am7	Bb7
	D	E	A
ROOT 1 KEY LEFT	D(maj7)	E(maj7)	A(maj7)
ROOT 2 KEYS LEFT	D7	E7	A7



SEVENTH CHORDS Q & A

Q - On piano websites they always show the 7 note added on top of the chord not below it - so aren't you teaching us the wrong way to make a 7th chord?

A - Not at all - adding the 7th below the chord is a 100% valid way to form a 7th chord.

Lets look at the chord of Cmaj7 - it has the notes C E G B (1 3 5 7)
These notes can be arranged in 4 different combinations - all of which are EQUALLY valid Cmaj7 chords.

1 3 5 7 - 3 5 7 1 - 5 7 1 3 - 7 1 3 5
C E G B - E G B C - G B C E - B C E G

we are using the last combination (B C E G) where the maj7 note is on the left
we can also omit the root note of the chord (the C note) because the left hand will be playing it.

So - Left Hand plays C and Right Hand plays B E G
so all 4 notes of Cmaj7 are still being played (C E G B)

The reason online sites show the 7 added on top is simply because that is the most logical way to DESCRIBE where the 7th note comes from.

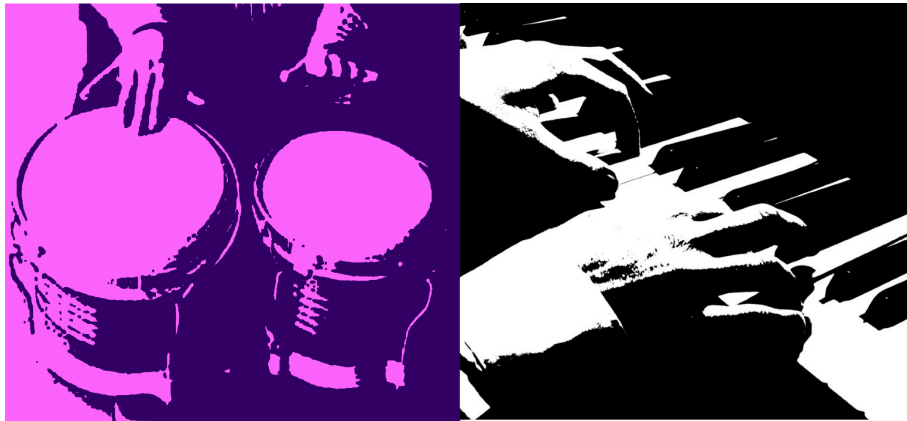
But that is not the easiest way to FORM a 7th chord in practice - it is MUCH easier to remember that a maj7 is just one key left of the root note of the chord and a 7 is two keys left of the root note - you can then form any 7th chord INSTANTLY.

Try adding the 7s on top for all your chords and you'll see how difficult it is.

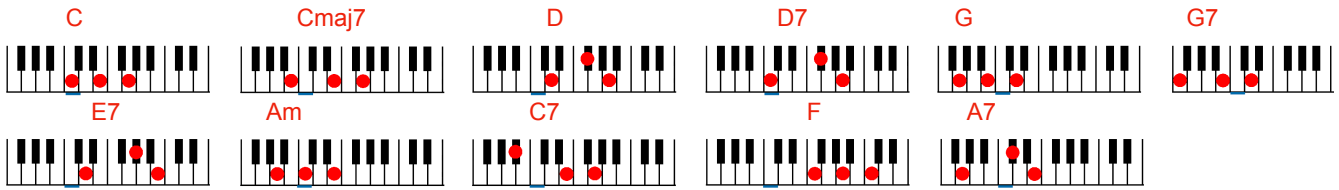
SEVENTH CHORDS

PRACTICE PROGRESSIONS

C FAMILY CHORDS and D, E, A, Bb

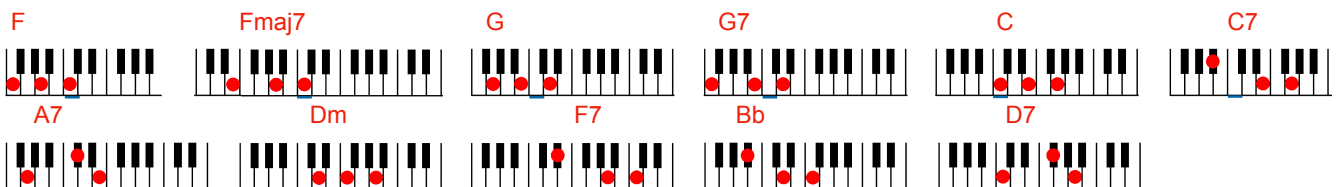


RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (Aura Lee / Love Me Tender)

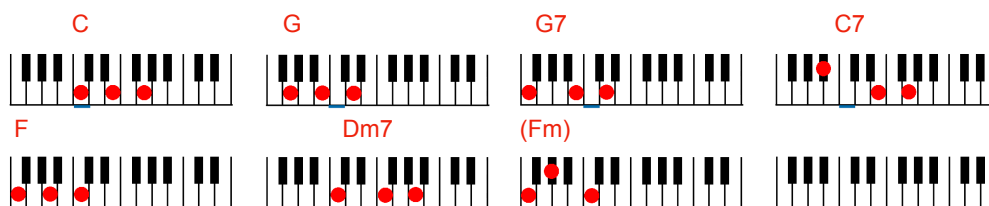


C Cmaj7 D D7 G G7 C C
 As the blackbird in the spring, 'neath the willow tree,
 C Cmaj7 D D7 G G7 C C
 Sat and piped, I heard him sing; sing of Aura Lee.
 C E7 Am C7 F C
 Aura Lee, Aura Lee, maid with golden hair.
 C A7 D7 G G7 C
 Sunshine came along with thee, and swallows in the air.

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (Aura Lee / Love Me Tender)

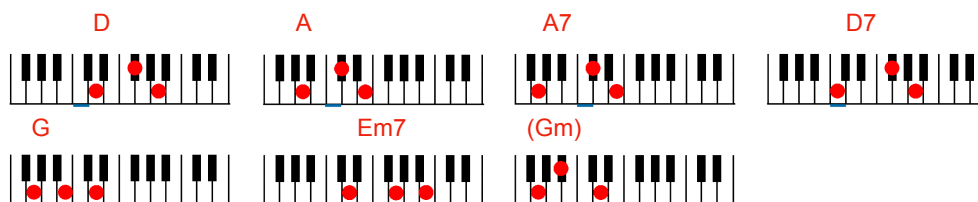


F Fmaj7 G G7 C C7 F F
 As the blackbird in the spring, 'neath the willow tree,
 F Fmaj7 G G7 C C7 F F
 Sat and piped, I heard him sing; sing of Aura Lee.
 F A7 Dm F7 Bb F
 Aura Lee, Aura Lee, maid with golden hair.
 F D7 G7 C C7 F
 Sunshine came along with thee, and swallows in the air.

RHYTHM: Oom Pah (Happy Birthday) in C **New Chord 'Fm'*

(C) C G
Happy Birth----day to you.
G7 C
Happy Birth---day to you.
C C7 F
Happy Birth----day dear
C G7 C
Happy Birth--day to you.

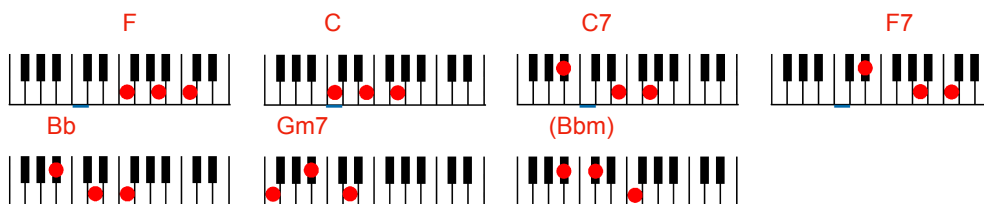
(C) C G7
Happy Birth----day to you.
Dm7 G7 C
Happy Birth----day to you.
C C7 F (Fm)
Happy Birth---day dear
C G7 C
Happy Birth---day to you.

RHYTHM: Oom Pah (Happy Birthday) in D **New Chord 'Gm'*

(D) D A
Happy Birth----day to you.
A7 D
Happy Birth---day to you.
D D7 G
Happy Birth----day dear
D A7 D
Happy Birth--day to you.

(D) D A7
Happy Birth----day to you.
Em7 A7 D
Happy Birth----day to you.
D D7 G (Gm)
Happy Birth---day dear
D A7 D
Happy Birth--day to you.

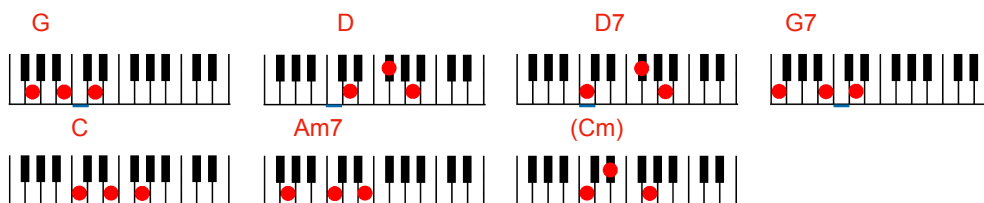
RHYTHM: Oom Pah (Happy Birthday) in F **New Chords 'Gm' - 'Bbm'*



(F) F C
Happy Birth----day to you.
C7 F
Happy Birth---day to you.
F F7 Bb
Happy Birth----day dear
F C7 F
Happy Birth--day to you.

(F) F C7
Happy Birth----day to you.
Gm7 C7 F
Happy Birth----day to you.
F F7 Bb (Bbm)
Happy Birth----day dear
F C7 F
Happy Birth--day to you.

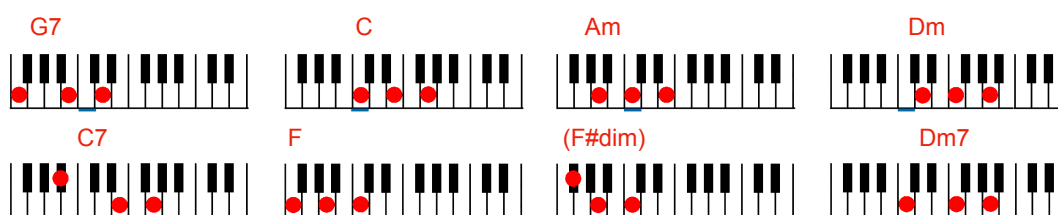
RHYTHM: Oom Pah (Happy Birthday) in G **New Chord 'Cm'*



(G) G D
Happy Birth----day to you.
D7 G
Happy Birth---day to you.
G G7 C
Happy Birth----day dear
G D7 G
Happy Birth--day to you.

(G) G D7
Happy Birth----day to you.
Am7 D7 G
Happy Birth----day to you.
G G7 C (Cm)
Happy Birth---day dear
G D7 G
Happy Birth--day to you.

RHYTHM: Slow half Beat Bounce (Auld Lang Syne) *extra chord F#dim



(G7) C Am Dm G7

Should old acquaintance be for - got,

C C7 F (F#dim)

And never brought to mind?

C Am Dm G7

Should old acquaintance be for - got,

Am Dm7 G7 C

And the days of auld lang syne?

RHYTHM: 6/8 Split (Silent Night)



G D D7 G G7

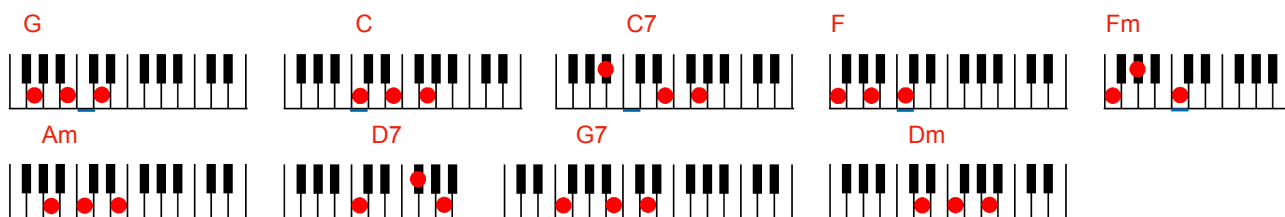
Silent night! Holy night! All is calm all is bright,

C G C G

Round yon virgin mother and child, Holy infant so tender and mild.

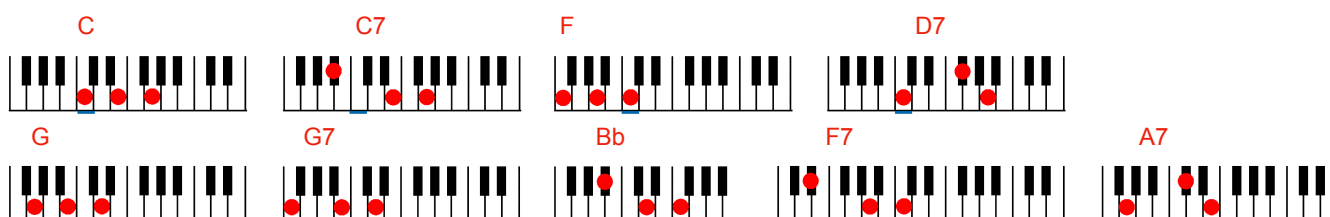
D D7 G Em G D G

Sleep in heavenly peace! Sleep in heavenly peace!

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (Oh Danny Boy) **Extra chord F minor*

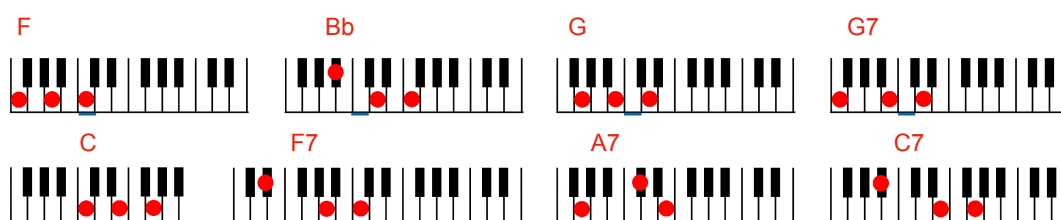
(G) C C7 F Fm
 Oh Danny Boy, the pipes, the pipes are calling,
 C Am D7 G7
 From glen to glen and down the mountainside,
 C C7 F Fm
 The summer's gone and all the roses falling
 C Am Dm G7 C F/C C
 It's you, It's you, must go, and I must bide.

RHYTHM: Oom Pah (In The Blue Ridge Mountains Of Virginia)



C C7 F D7 G G7 C C7 F Bb C7
 In, The, Blue Ridge Mountains of Virginia, On the trail of the lonesome pine.
 F D7 G
 In the pale moon shine, Our hearts entwined.
 G7 C7 G7 C7
 Where she carved her name, And I carved mine.
 F F7 Bb A7
 Oh, June, Like the mountains I'm blue, Like the pine, I am lonesome for you.
 C C7 F D7 G G7 C C7 F Bb F
 In, The, Blue Ridge Mountains of Virginia, On the trail of the lonesome pine.

RHYTHM: Oom Pah #1 or #2 (It's A Long Way To Tipperary)



F

It's a long way to Tipperary,

Bb F

It's a long way to go.

F

It's a long way to Tipperary,

G G7 C

To the sweetest girl I know!

F F7

Goodbye, Piccadilly,

Bb A7

Farewell, Leicester Square!

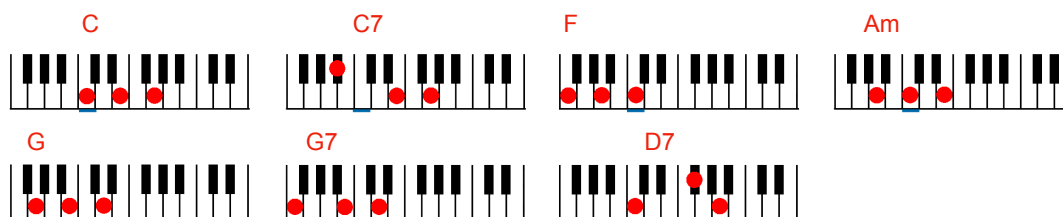
F Bb F

It's a long long way to Tippera---ry,

G C7 F

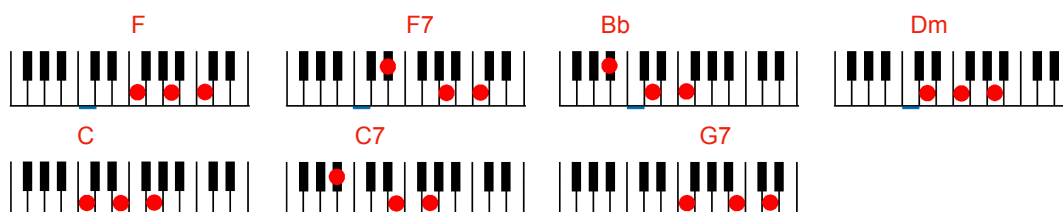
But my heart's right there.

RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce / 6/8 Split (Swing Low Sweet Chariot)



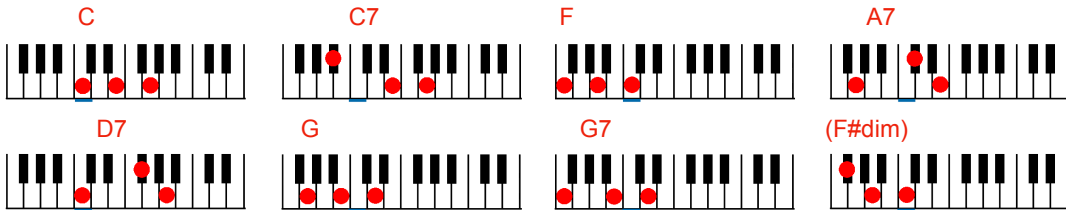
C C7 F C
 Swing low, sweet char----iot
 C Am G G7
 coming for to carry me home.
 C C7 F C
 Swing low, sweet char--iot
 Am D7 G7 C F C
 coming for to carry me home.

RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce / 6/8 Split (Swing Low Sweet Chariot)



F F7 Bb F
 Swing low, sweet char----iot
 F Dm C C7
 coming for to carry me home.
 F F7 Bb F
 Swing low, sweet char--iot
 Dm G7 C7 F Bb F
 coming for to carry me home.

RHYTHM: Oom Pah Pah (When Irish Eyes Are Smiling) **Extra chord F#dim*



C C7 F C
 When Irish eyes are smiling, sure'n tis like a morn in spring.
 F C A7 D7 G
 In the lilt of Irish laughter, You can hear the angels sing.
 C C7 F C
 When Irish hearts are happy, All the world seems bright and gay.
 F (F#dim) C A7 D7 G7 C
 And when Irish eyes are smiling, Sure they steal your heart a--way.

RHYTHM: Oom Pah (This Land Is Your Land - Woody Guthrie)



(D) G D
 This land is your land, and this land is my land.
 A D D7
 From California, to the New York Island.
 G D
 From the Redwood Forest, to the Gulf stream waters,
 A D
 This land was made for you and me.

RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Drive - *The Cars*) In G



G	Gmaj7	G	Gmaj7	
---	-------	---	-------	--

Chorus

Em	Am	Em	Am	G	Gmaj7	G	Gmaj7
----	----	----	----	---	-------	---	-------

RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Drive - *The Cars*) In C



C	Cmaj7	C	Cmaj7	
---	-------	---	-------	--

Chorus

Am	Dm	Am	Dm	C	Cmaj7	C	Cmaj7
----	----	----	----	---	-------	---	-------

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... When A Man Loves A Woman - *Michael Bolton*)



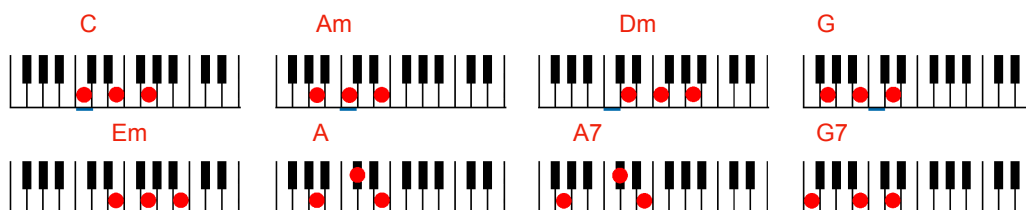
C	G	Am7	C	F	G7	C	G
---	---	-----	---	---	----	---	---

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... The Way You Look Tonight)



Cmaj7	Am7	Dm7	G7	Cmaj7	Am7	Dm7	G7
Cmaj7	Am7	Dm7	G7	Cmaj7			

RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Try A Little Tenderness - Otis Redding)



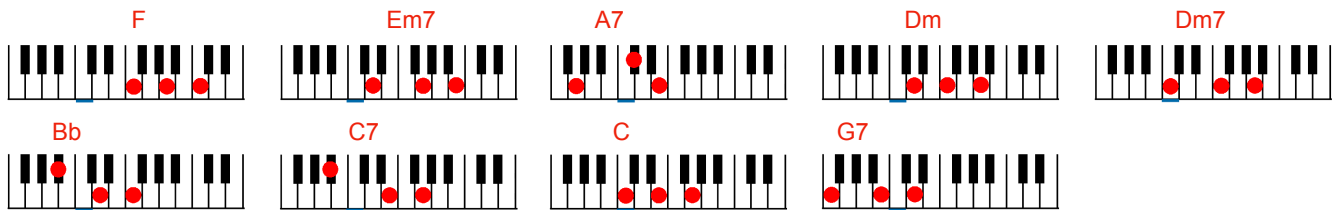
C	Am	Dm	G	C	Em	A	A7
Dm	Dm	G	G7	C	Am	Dm	G

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Love Me Tender - Elvis)



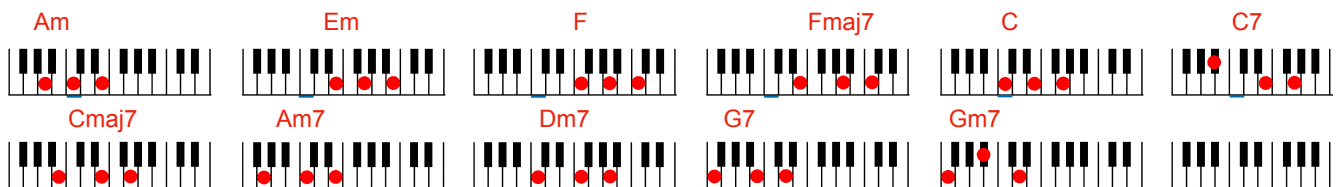
G	Gmaj7	A	A7	D	D7	G	G
G	G	A	A7	D	D7	G	G

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Yesterday - Beatles)



F	Em7	A7	Dm	Dm7	Bb	C7
F	C	Dm7	G7	Bb	F	

RHYTHM: HBB (In the style of... The Long And Winding Road - Beatles) *Extra chord Gm7



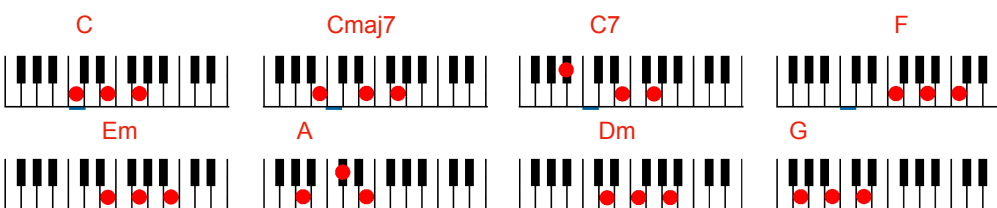
Am	Em	F	Fmaj7	C	C7	F	Fmaj7
C	Cmaj7	Am	Am7	Dm7	G7	Gm7	C7

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Something - Beatles)



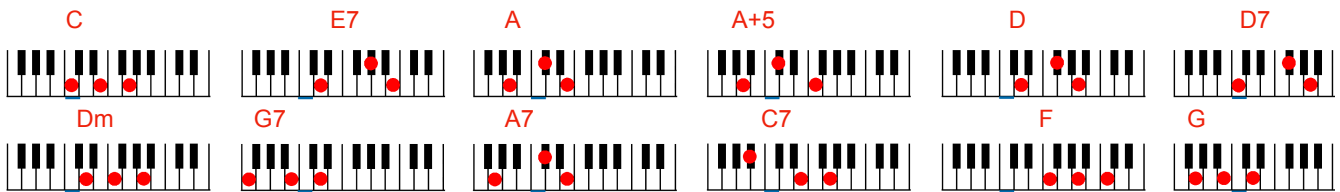
G	Gmaj7	G7	C
---	-------	----	---

RHYTHM: Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Raindrops Keep Fallin' On My Head)



C	Cmaj7	C7	F	Em	A	Em	A	Dm	Dm7	G
---	-------	----	---	----	---	----	---	----	-----	---

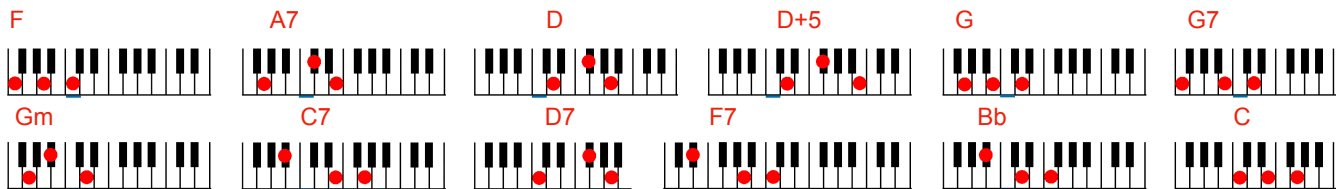
RHYTHM: Oom Pah (In the style of... We'll Meet Again - Vera Lynn / Johnny Cash) in C



C	E7	A	A+5	D	D7	Dm	G7
C	E7	A	A7	D7	Dm G7	C	C

C7	C7	F	F	D	D7	G	G
----	----	---	---	---	----	---	---

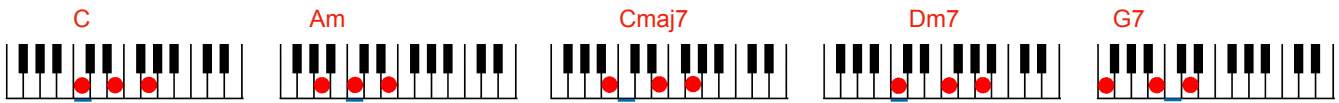
RHYTHM: Oom Pah (In the style of... We'll Meet Again) in F **Extra chord 'Gm'*



F	A7	D	D+5	G	G7	Gm	C7
F	A7	D	D7	G7	Gm C7	F	F

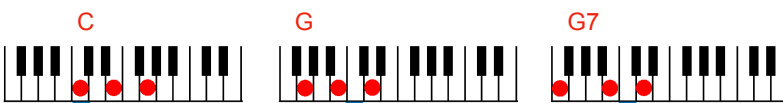
F7	F7	Bb	Bb	G	G7	C	C
----	----	----	----	---	----	---	---

RHYTHM: 'Snappy' Oom Pah (In the style of... Hello Dolly - *Barbara Streisand*)



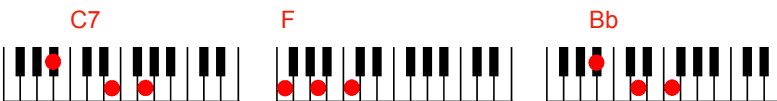
C	C	Am	Am	Cmaj7	Cmaj7	Dm7	G7
---	---	----	----	-------	-------	-----	----

RHYTHM: Country Oom Pah (In the style of... Jambalaya - *Hank Williams*)



C	C	G	G	G	G7	C	C
C	C	G	G	G	G7	C	C

RHYTHM: Country Oom Pah (In the style of... I Walk The Line - *Johnny Cash*)



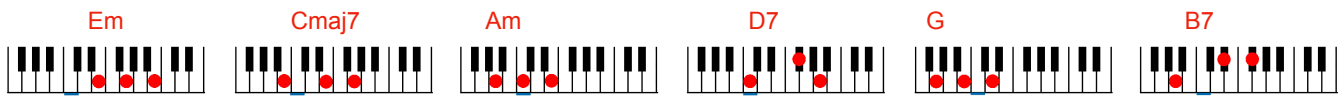
C7	C7	F	F	C7	C7	F	F
Bb	Bb	F	F	C7	C7	F	F

RHYTHM: Oom Pah (In the style of... The Bear Necessities - *Jungle Book*)



F	F	Bb	Bb	F	D7	G	C7
---	---	----	----	---	----	---	----

RHYTHM: Oom Pah Pah (In the style of... Raindrops On Roses - *Sound Of Music*) * Extra chord 'B7'



Em	Em	Em	Em	Cmaj7	Cmaj7	Cmaj7	Cmaj7
Am	D7	G	C	G	C	Am/F#	B7

RHYTHM: Oom Pah Pah (In the style of... Edelweiss - *Sound Of Music*)



C	G	C	F	C	Am	Dm7	G7
C	G	C	F	C	G7	C	C

RHYTHM: Oom Pah Pah (In the style of... Oom Pah Pah - *From the musical Oliver*)



Bb	Bb	C7	C7	F7	F7	Bb	Bb
Bb	Bb	C7	C7	F7	F7	Bb	Bb

'6th' chords



HOW TO MAKE A 6TH CHORD

You will play 7th chords a LOT - but every now and then you will come across '6th' chords such as Em6 - C6 - F6 - Eb6 and so on.

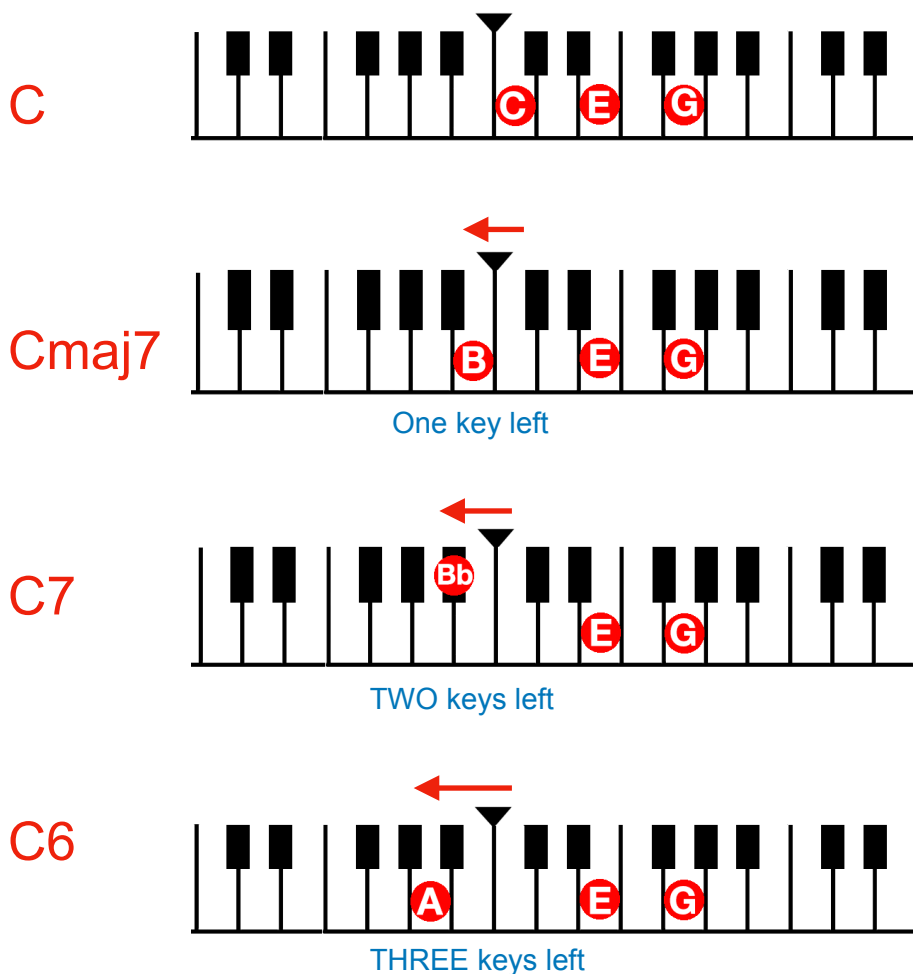
Don't worry - now that you've learned how to form seventh chords - adding a sixth is very easy.

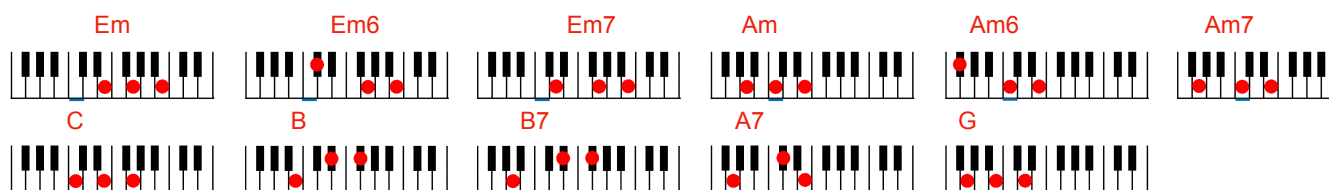
You learned that to make a 'maj7' just move the root note ONE key left.

or to make a '7' chord move the root note TWO keys left.

To make a 6th chord we just move the root note THREE keys to the left.

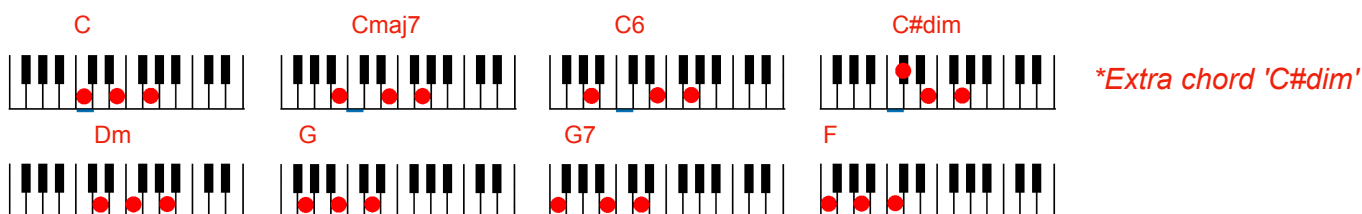
So if we use the chord of C as an example.



RHYTHM: Slow Half Beat Bounce (Summertime - Gershwin) **Extra chords 'B' and 'B7'*


Em	Em6	Em7	Em6	Em	Em6	Em7	Em6
Am	Am6	Am7	C/G	B	Am	B	B7

Em	Em6	Em7	Em6	Em	Em6	Em7	A7
G	Em	A7	Am7	Em	Em6	Em7	Em6

RHYTHM: Oom Pah Pah (Que Sera Sera - Doris Day) *"When I was just a little girl I asked my mother..."*


C	Cmaj7	C6	Cmaj7	C	C#dim	Dm	G
G	G	G	G	G7	G7	C	C

F	F	F	F	C	C	C	C	G	G
G	G	C	C	Dm	G	C	C	C	



LESSONS CHECKPOINT



1-202

SEVENTHS can be difficult to understand at first.

- ☐ Do you understand how to form the seventh chords? Where do we get the seventh note? Why is it given the number 7?
- ☐ Do you understand why we add the 7 below the chord rather than on top?
- ☐ How many keys to the left of the root note of a chord is a 'maj7'?
- ☐ How many keys to the left of the root note of a chord is a '7'?
- ☐ What note do you play in the left hand when you play seventh chords?
- ☐ Can you add maj7 or 7 to all the chords you know so far?
- ☐ Were you able to play the seventh chords in the practice progressions? Can you hear the difference they make and how they add to the sound?
- ☐ Did you understand how to form a 6th chord? How many keys to the left do you move the root note?

If you are unsure about forming 7th chords go over the chapter again VERY CAREFULLY.

It's actually easier than it seems. Just two simple rules...

To add a maj7 - move the root note of the right hand chord 1 key left.

To add a 7 - move the root note of the right hand chord 2 keys left.

The left hand doesn't change - it still plays the root note one octave below the right hand.

RHYTHM # 7

SPLIT CHORD



SPLIT CHORD RHYTHM

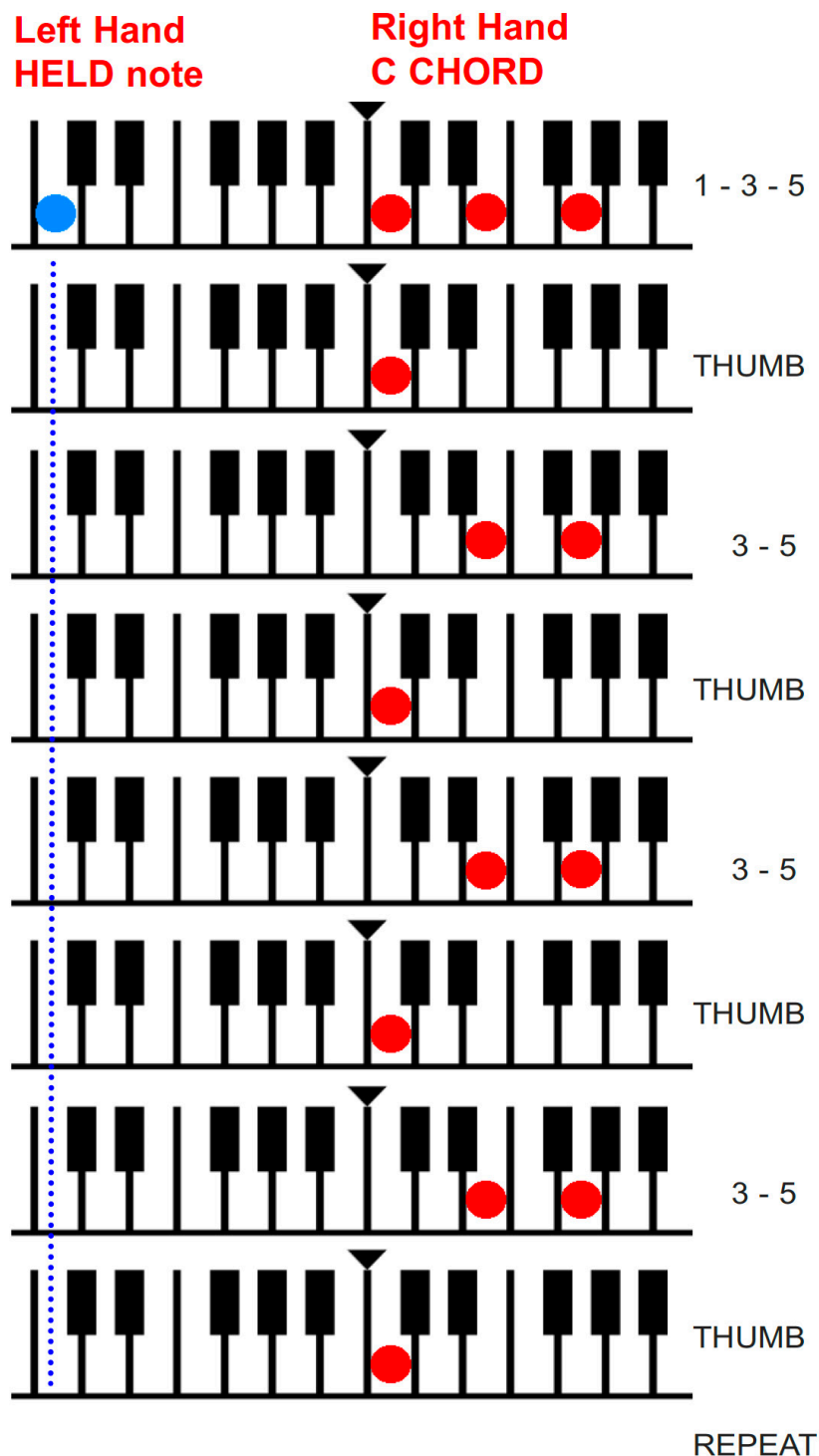
This rhythm is created by SPLITTING the RIGHT hand chord up, between your THUMB and (3rd and 5th fingers).

Play the WHOLE chord first - then the THUMB only then the 3rd & 5th fingers TOGETHER - then the thumb again - and so on.

Your LEFT hand plays the single chord note (one octave left) and holds it.

Try it with a
C chord

HOLD THE
PEDAL
DOWN
THROUGHOUT



Here's what it looks like as MUSICAL NOTATION

Remember - look at the SHAPES and PATTERNS

RIGHT HAND
C Chord

1-3-5 Thumb 3-5 Thumb 3-5 Thumb 3-5 Thumb

Count 1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and

LEFT HAND
C note HELD

Keep the sustain pedal down throughout

Now we can add in some sevenths
and create some great sounds

Try the following 2 bar changes that has been used at the start of countless songs like **IMAGINE** by John Lennon.

Thumb one left

C **Cmaj7** **F**

1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and 1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and

C C F

← PEDAL → ← PEDAL → ← PEDAL →



Keep the sustain pedal down
over each chord change

SPLIT CHORD - VARIATION

The basic SPLIT CHORD rhythm starts with all three notes of the chord (in the right hand) then the thumb, then the top two notes then the thumb and so on.

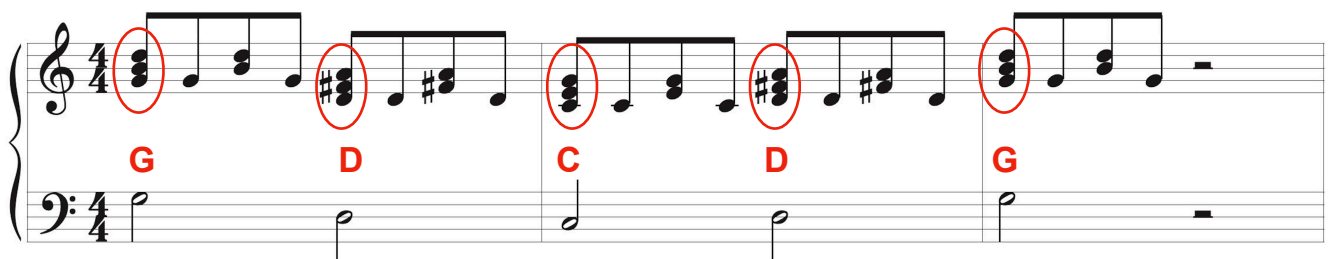
When you are changing chords you don't always HAVE to play all three notes together at the start of each chord change.

You can just start with the top two notes then the thumb and so on
This can be easier to play and can flow better.

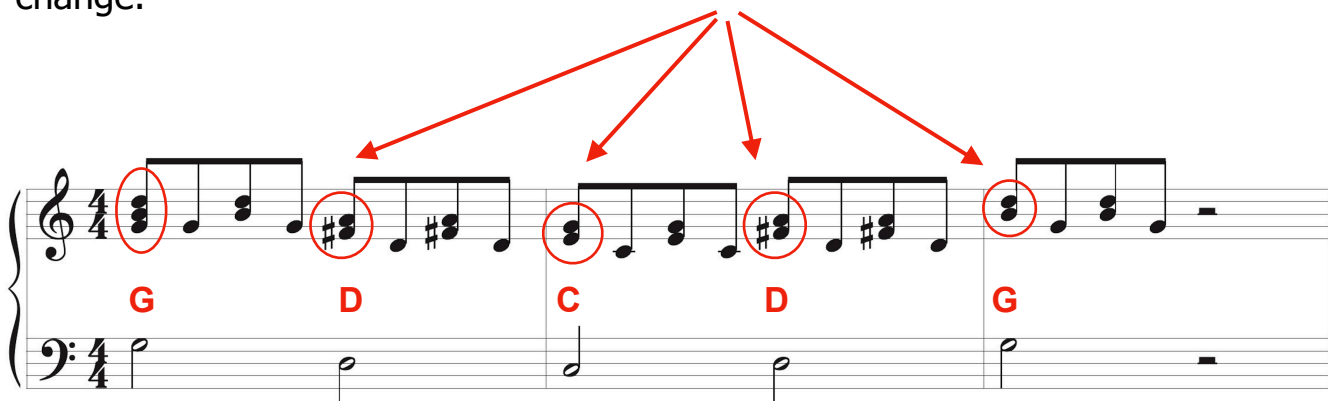
So there are TWO ways to play the rhythm.

1. ALL THREE NOTES at start of each chord change.

RHYTHM: Split Chord (You Say Nothing At All - Notting Hill - "It's amazing how you can..")



2. All three notes at the very start, but just the top two notes for each chord change.

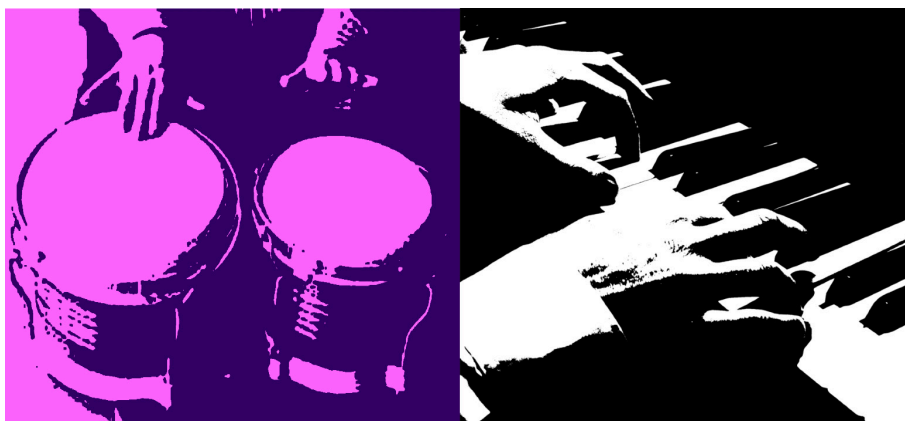


It's up to YOU what way to play the split chord when you play the progressions.

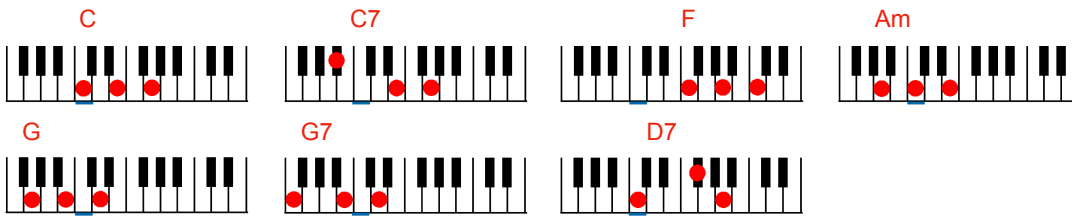
SPLIT CHORD RHYTHM and more SEVENTHS

PRACTICE PROGRESSIONS

C FAMILY CHORDS / D, E, A, Bb

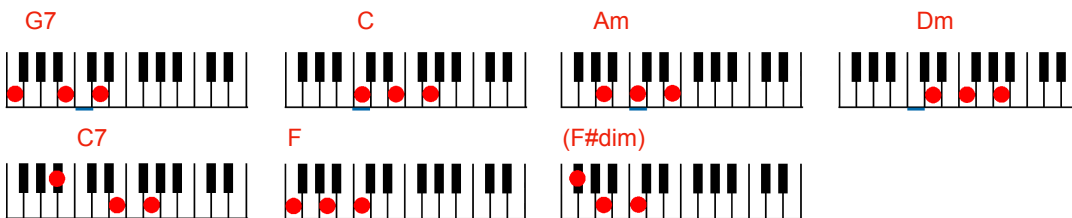


RHYTHM: Split Chord (Swing Low Sweet Chariot)

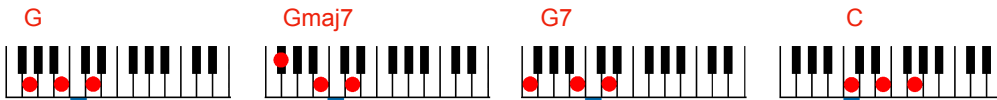


C C7 F C
 Swing low, sweet char---iot,
 C Am G G7
 coming for to carry me home.
 C C7 F C
 Swing low, sweet char--iot,
 Am D7 G7 C
 coming for to carry me home.

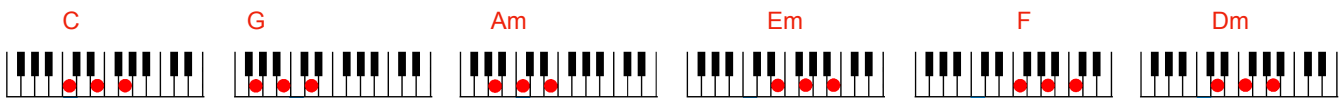
RHYTHM: Split Chord (Auld Lang Syne)



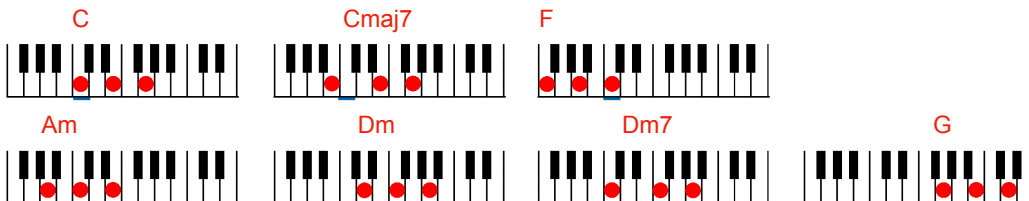
(G7) C Am Dm G7
 Should old acquaintance be for - got,
 C C7 F (F#dim)
 And never brought to mind?
 C Am Dm G7
 Should old acquaintance be for - got,
 F G7 C
 And the days of auld lang syne?

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Something - *Beatles*)

G	Gmaj7	G7	C
---	-------	----	---

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Streets Of London - *Ralph McTell*)

C	G	Am	Em	F	C	Dm	G
---	---	----	----	---	---	----	---

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Imagine - *Beatles*)

C	Cmaj7	F	<i>Repeat 4 times</i>
F	Am	Dm	Dm7
			G

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Unchained Melody - *Righteous Brothers*)

G	Em	Cmaj7	D7	G	Em	D	D7
---	----	-------	----	---	----	---	----

RHYTHM: Fast Split Chord (In the style of... Hey There Delilah - *Plain White T's*) in C

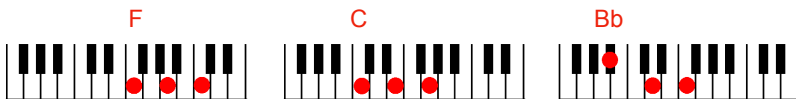


C	Em	C	Em	Am	F	G	Am	G
---	----	---	----	----	---	---	----	---

Chorus

C	Am	C	Am	C	Am	C	Am	C
---	----	---	----	---	----	---	----	---

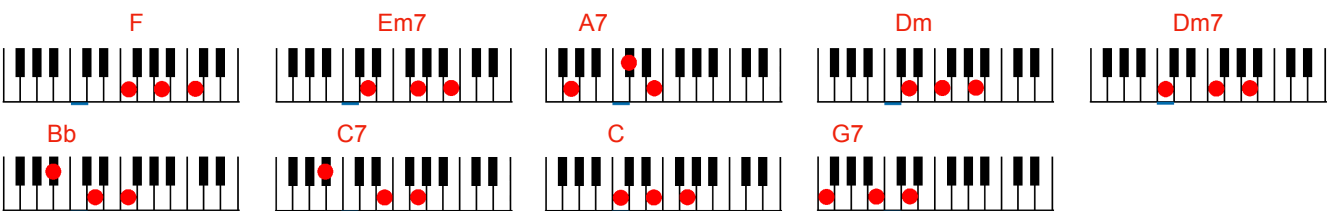
RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Everything I Do I Do It For You - Bryan Adams) F



Verse

look into my	F	C	Bb	C	<i>Repeat</i>
--------------	---	---	----	---	---------------

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Yesterday - *Beatles*)



F	Em7	A7	Dm	Dm7	Bb	C7
F	C	Dm7	G7	Bb	F	

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Jealous Guy - John Lennon)

G	Em	D	D7	Em	Em6	D	Em	C
---	----	---	----	----	-----	---	----	---

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Have Yourself A Merry Little Christmas)

Cmaj7	Am7	Dm7	G7	Repeat
-------	-----	-----	----	--------

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Someone You Loved - Lewis Capaldi)*Intro + verses + chorus*

C	G	Am	F
---	---	----	---

RHYTHM: Split Chord / Half Beat Bounce (In the style of... Falling Slowly - From the film Once)*Verse - Split Chord*

C	F	C	F	C	F	C	F
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---

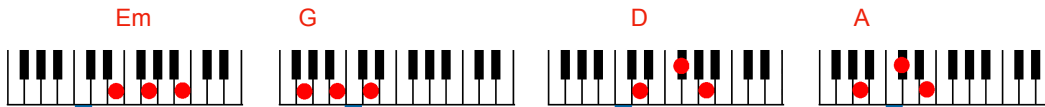
Pre Chorus - Half Beat Bounce

Am	G	F	G	Am	G	F
----	---	---	---	----	---	---

Chorus - Split Chord

C	F	Am	F	Repeat
---	---	----	---	--------

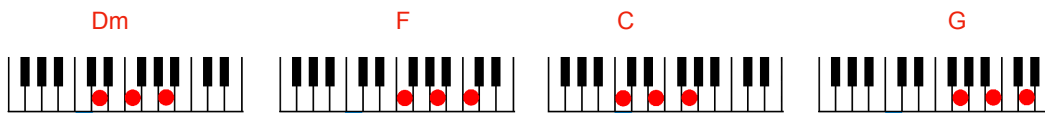
RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Boulevard of broken dreams - *Green Day*) Em



Intro and Verses

Em	G	D	A	<i>Repeat</i>
----	---	---	---	---------------

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Boulevard of broken dreams - *Green Day*) Dm



Intro and Verses

Dm	F	C	G	<i>Repeat</i>
----	---	---	---	---------------

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Never Say You Can't - *Bruno Mars*)



Intro & Verse

F	C	Dm	C	Bb	<i>Repeat</i>
---	---	----	---	----	---------------

RHYTHM: Split Chord (In the style of... Never Say You Cant - *Bruno Mars*) in C



Intro & Verse

C	G	Am	G	F	<i>Repeat</i>
---	---	----	---	---	---------------

LEFT NOTE / RIGHT SPLIT CHORD

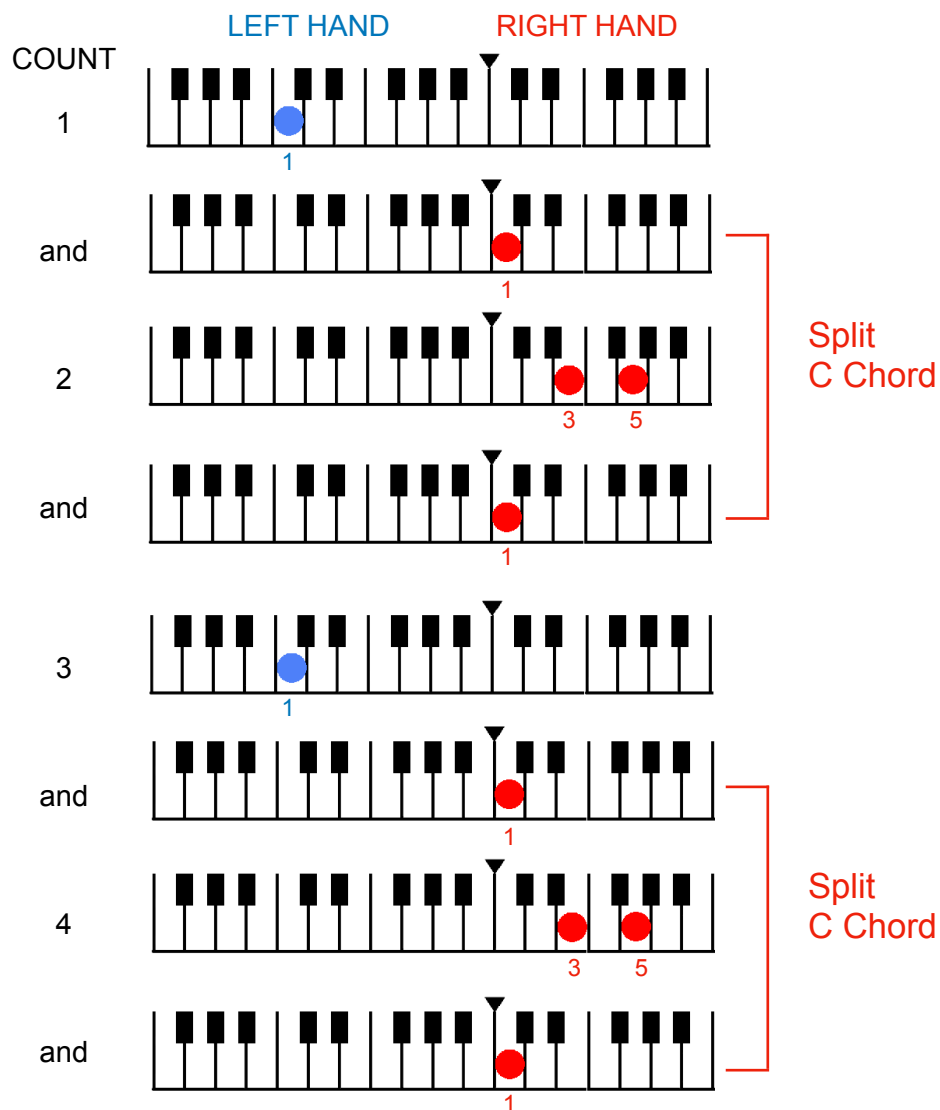
1-213

This new rhythm is a mix between Left Note / Right Chord and the Split Chord Rhythm you just learned.

Lets try it with a C chord.

Play a C bass note one octave below middle C in your LEFT HAND.

Then you are going to play a split C chord in your right hand - thumb first then top two notes then thumb again - then repeat for the second half of the bar.



LEFT NOTE / RIGHT SPLIT CHORD

1-214

Rhythmic variations

The LEFT NOTE / RIGHT SPLIT CHORD rhythm can be played with some variations.

Two patterns per bar - one pattern per chord.

Two patterns per bar - one pattern per chord. The notation shows two measures in 4/4 time. The first measure contains two patterns: the first pattern is a quarter note C in the bass and a half note G in the treble; the second pattern is a quarter note G in the bass and a half note F in the treble. The second measure contains two patterns: the first pattern is a quarter note F in the bass and a half note G in the treble; the second pattern is a quarter note G in the bass and a half note F in the treble. The chords are labeled C, G, F, and G in red.

Two patterns per bar - same chord

Two patterns per bar - same chord. The notation shows four measures in 4/4 time. The first two measures contain two patterns per bar, both for the C chord. The first pattern is a quarter note C in the bass and a half note G in the treble; the second pattern is a quarter note G in the bass and a half note C in the treble. The next two measures contain two patterns per bar, both for the F chord. The first pattern is a quarter note F in the bass and a half note C in the treble; the second pattern is a quarter note C in the bass and a half note F in the treble. The chords are labeled C, C, F, and F in red.

One pattern per bar

One pattern per bar. The notation shows four measures in 4/4 time. The first measure contains one pattern: a quarter note C in the bass and a half note G in the treble. The second measure contains one pattern: a quarter note Am in the bass and a half note C in the treble. The third measure contains one pattern: a quarter note F in the bass and a half note C in the treble. The fourth measure contains one pattern: a quarter note G in the bass and a half note C in the treble. The chords are labeled C, Am, F, and G in red.

RHYTHM: Left Note Right Split Chord (In the style of... All I Have To Do Is Dream - *Everly Brothers*)



C	Am	Dm	G	Keep repeating
---	----	----	---	----------------

RHYTHM: Left Note Right Split Chord (In the style of... Happier - *Ed Sheeran*)



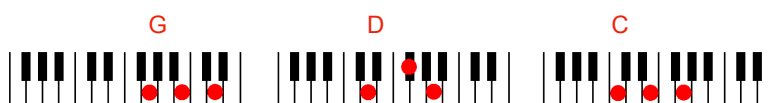
Am	F	C	Keep repeating
----	---	---	----------------

RHYTHM: Left Note Right Split Chord (In the style of... Mad World - *Gary Jules*)



Dm	F	C	G	Repeat
----	---	---	---	--------

RHYTHM: LN/RC Split (In the style of... You Say Nothing At All - *Notting Hill*) in G



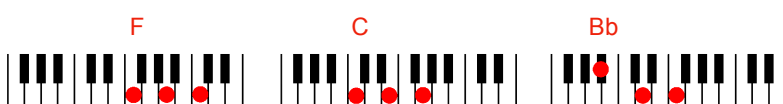
LN/RC Split

G	D	C	D	<i>Repeat x 4</i>
---	---	---	---	-------------------

Half Beat Bounce

C	D	G	D/F#	C/E	D	<i>and so on</i>
---	---	---	------	-----	---	------------------

RHYTHM: LN/RC Split (In the style of... You Say Nothing At All - *Notting Hill*) in F



LN/RC Split

F	C	Bb	C	<i>Repeat x 4</i>
---	---	----	---	-------------------

Half Beat Bounce

Bb	C	F	C/E	Bb/D	C	<i>and so on</i>
----	---	---	-----	------	---	------------------

MELODIC INTERLUDE #5



Greensleeves
What Child Is This
&
It's Only The Fairytale

MELODIC INTERLUDE #5 GREENSLEEVES

For this melodic interlude we are going to experiment with different patterns to play the song GREENSLEEVES / WHAT CHILD IS THIS.

1. Broken Chords Pattern #1 (over 2 Octaves)
2. Broken Chords Pattern #2 (over 4 Octaves)
3. 1-5-123 pattern
4. 1-5-123-5-1 pattern
5. A 'Split Chord' pattern - with and without the melody

GREENSLEEVES HAS AN UNDERLYING 3 BEAT PULSE

If you search online for the sheet music for Greensleeves you will see it with different time signatures.

3/4 (3 beats per bar)

6/8 (6 half beats per bar)

12/8 (12 half beats per bar)

Which is a bit confusing!

Just keep in mind that all these timings are divisible by 3 - so the underlying pulse is 3 or multiples of 3.

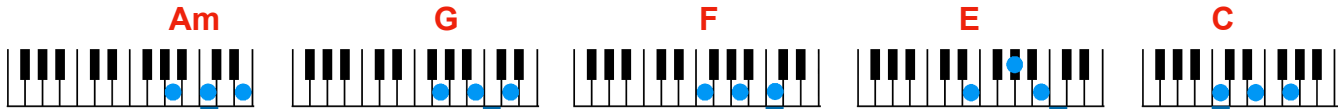
Strictly speaking - Greensleeves is in 6/8 time but we are going to make use of ALL THREE timings to play the different rhythms because with particular patterns its simply easier to COUNT using either 3/4 - 6/8 or 12/8.

DON'T WORRY - you will STILL end up playing Greensleeves.

It would just add a LOT of unnecessary confusion to explain the theory.

MELODIC INTERLUDE #5 GREENSLEEVES

The chords used in the song are **Am G F E** (and **C** in the chorus)



Greensleeves

[Verse 1]

Am **Am** **G** **G**
 Alas my love, you do me wrong,
F **F** **E** **E**
 to cast me off so discourteously,
Am **Am** **G** **G**
 for I have loved you so long,
F **E** **Am** **Am**
 delighting in your com—pany.

[Chorus]

C **C** **G** **G**
 Greensleeves was all my joy,
F **F** **E** **E**
 Greensleeves was my delight,
C **C** **G** **G**
 Greensleeves was my heart of gold,
F **E** **Am** **Am**
 and who but my lady Green—sleeves.

MELODIC INTERLUDE #5 GREENSLEEVES

The same melody (and chord progression) for Greensleeves is also used for the song 'What Child Is This' - a Christmas carol whose lyrics were written by William Chatterton Dix, in 1865 (listen to Josh Groban's version on YouTube).

What Child Is This

(using the melody of Greensleeves)

[Verse 1]

^{Am} What ^{Am} child is this - ^G who ^G lay to rest
^F On ^F Mary's ^E lap is ^E slee—ping.
^{Am} Whom ^{Am} angels ^G greet with ^G anthems ^G sweet,
^F While ^E shepherds ^{Am} watch ^{Am} are ^{Am} kee—ping.

[Verse 2]

^{Am} So ^{Am} bring him ^G incense, ^G gold and ^G myrrh.
^F Come ^F peasant ^E king to ^E own him.
^{Am} The ^{Am} King of ^G Kings ^G salvation ^G brings
^F Let ^E loving ^{Am} hearts ^{Am} enthrone him

[Chorus]

^C This, ^C this is ^G Christ the ^G King,
^F Whom ^F shepherds ^E guard and ^E angels ^E sing.
^C Haste, ^C haste to ^G bring him ^G laud,
^F The ^E Babe, ^{Am} the ^{Am} Son of ^{Am} Ma.....ry.

ETC..

Greensleeves - Broken Chord Patterns

1-221

LET'S START WITH THE BROKEN CHORD PATTERN

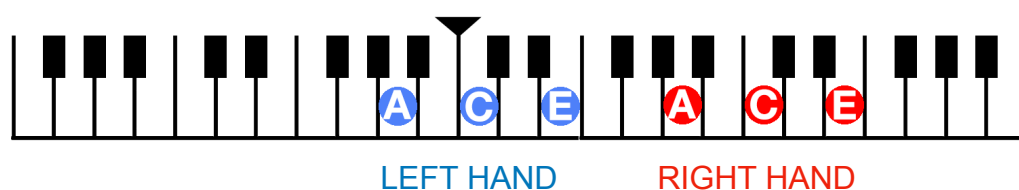
The BROKEN CHORD patterns are similar to 'The Amazing Broken Chord Ballad'.

Every chord is 'broken' up with each note being played one at a time from bottom to top.

Let's try the pattern over the first chord - Am.

You play a broken Am chord in the LEFT HAND starting on the A note just below middle C - so you play A, then C, then E.

Then you play another broken Am chord in the RIGHT HAND starting on an A note in the octave above the left hand chord - again you play A, then C, then E.



We repeat this over 2 bars.

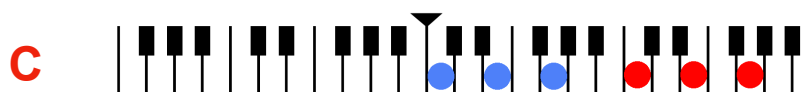
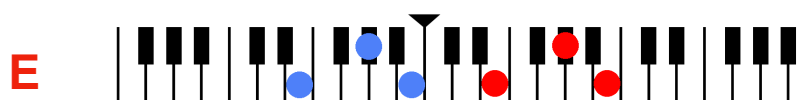
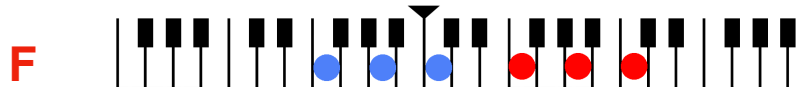
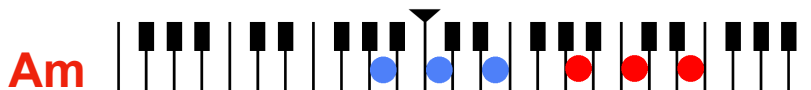
Because we play 6 'half beats' (eighth notes) in each bar we will play it as 6/8 time.

A musical score for the broken Am chord pattern in 6/8 time. The score consists of two bars. Each bar has a treble clef and a bass clef. The right hand (treble) plays a broken Am chord (A, C, E) in the upper register, with fingerings 1, 3, 5. The left hand (bass) plays a broken Am chord (A, C, E) in the lower register, with fingerings 5, 3, 1. A green arrow labeled 'PEDAL' points from the left hand to the right hand, indicating a sustained pedal point. The count '1 2 3 4 5 6' is written below the staff for each bar.

COUNT " 1 2 3 4 5 6 1 2 3 4 5 6"

Greensleeves - Broken Chords Pattern #1 (2 Octaves)

Now you APPLY the pattern to the other chords in the song.
(Don't forget the G# note in the E chord).



For the Chorus

PEDAL

Am 1 3 5 A C E 5 3 1 A C E 5 3 1 A C E 5 3 1 A C E

G 1 3 5 G B D 5 3 1 G B D 5 3 1 G B D 5 3 1 G B D

F 1 3 5 F A C 5 3 1 F A C 5 3 1 F A C 5 3 1 F A C

E 1 3 5 E G# B 5 3 1 E G# B 5 3 1 E G# B 5 3 1 E G# B

I'll leave it to you to apply the formula to the rest of the chords in the song.
Follow the page with the lyrics and chords written above them.

So over TWO bars, you play the same broken chord ascending over 4 octaves.

Again - I'll leave it to you to apply the formula to the rest of the chords in the song. Follow the page with the lyrics and chords written above them.

Greensleeves 1-5-123 pattern

1-224

You can also use the 1-5-123 pattern (from Melodic Interlude #2).

BUT THIS TIME you only ASCEND - you don't descend (watch the video).

Left Hand Right Hand

Am

FINGERING 5 2 1 2 3

G

5 2 1 2 3

F

5 2 1 2 3

E

5 2 1 2 3

C

5 2 1 2 3

PEDAL over each chord change ETC

Am **Am** **G** **G**

F **F** **E** **E**

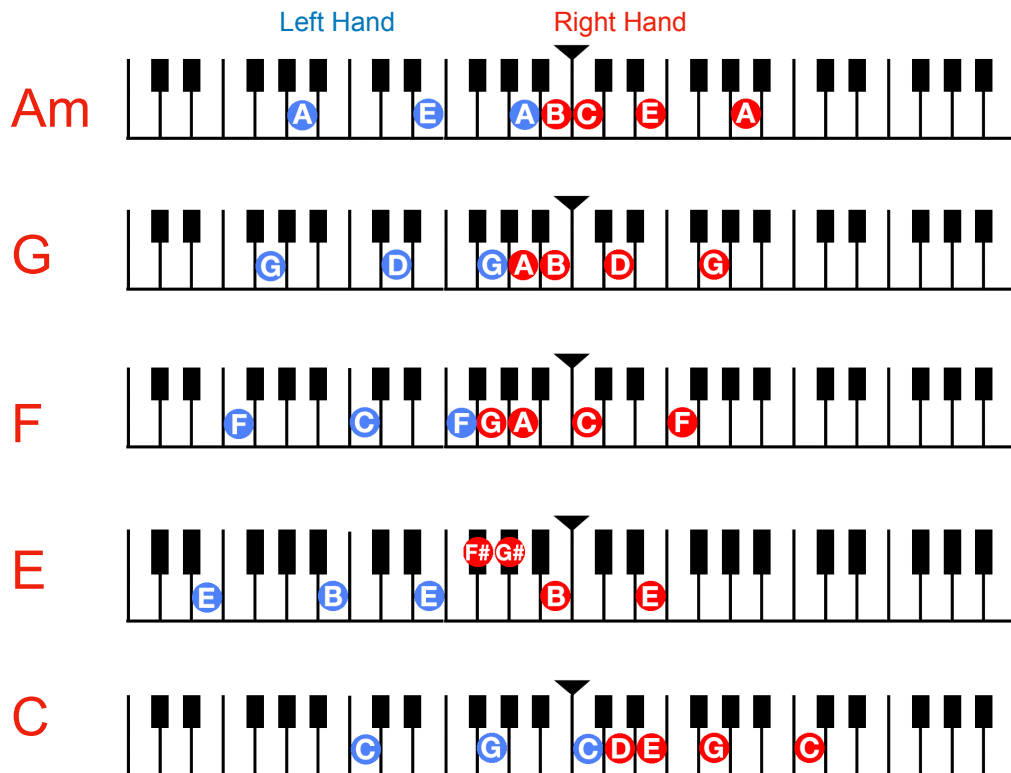
I'll leave it to you to apply the formula to the rest of the chords in the song.
Follow the page with the lyrics and chords written above them.

Greensleeves 1-5-123-5-1 pattern

1-225

You can also use the 1-5-123-5-1 pattern (Like Melodic Interlude #3).

Because the 1-5-123-5-1 pattern is a 12/8 pattern, you play each bar as if it is two chords per bar.



PEDAL over each chord change ETC

Am: Treble (1 2 3 5 3 2), Bass (5 2 1 A E A)

G: Treble (B C E A E C), Bass (B 1 1 2 A E G D G A B D G D B A G D)

F: Treble (3 F), Bass (F C F G A C F G A G F C F)

E: Treble (E), Bass (E B E F# G# B E B G# F# E B)

Again - I'll leave it to you to apply the formula to the rest of the chords in the song. Follow the page with the lyrics and chords written above them.

Greensleeves Split-Chord Pattern

1-226

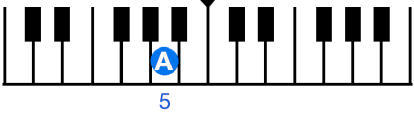
Let's try a SPLIT CHORD rhythm with the first chord Am - **in the LEFT HAND!!**

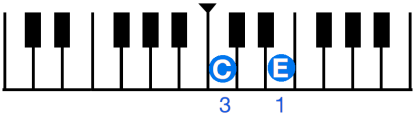
First play the A note just below middle C with the pinky finger of your LEFT hand
Then play the other two notes of the chord (C E) with your middle finger and thumb TWICE - **Then repeat the whole sequence again.**

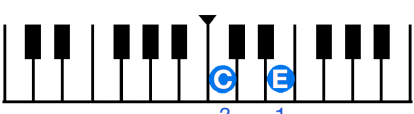
This time you will count THREE beats to the bar (3/4 time) to make it easier to follow.

LEFT HAND

COUNT **Am**

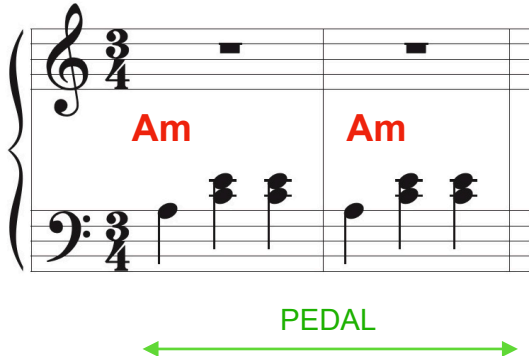
"ONE" 

"TWO" 

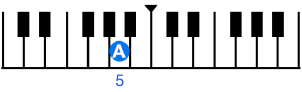
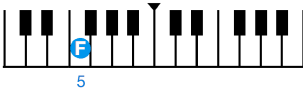
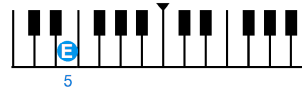
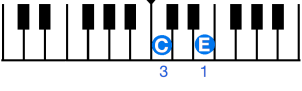
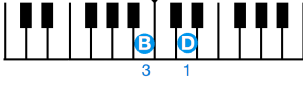
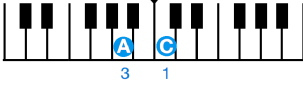
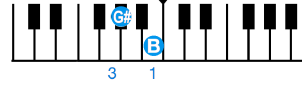
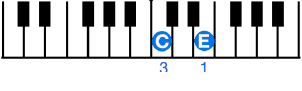
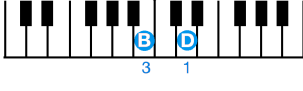
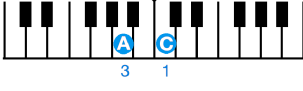
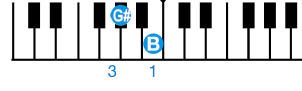
"THREE" 

REPEAT

In Sheet Music it looks like this

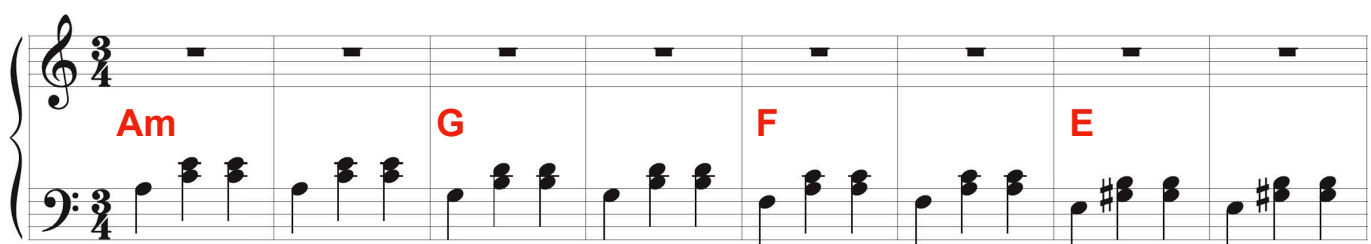


Now APPLY this rhythm to the 4 chords **Am (x2) - G (x2) - F (x2) - E (x2)**
Notice that the left hand just moves down one white key each chord change.

Am (x2)	G (x2)	F (x2)	E (x2)
			
			
			

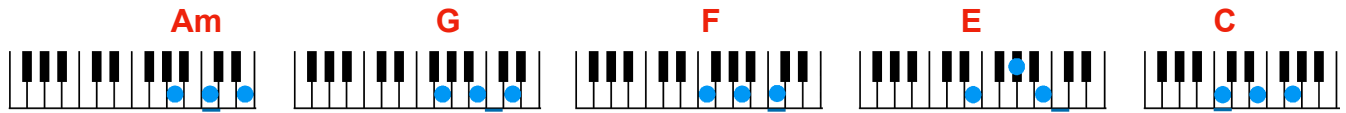
In Sheet Music it looks like this

In the E chord watch out for the G# note



Greensleeves Split-Chord Pattern

Ok - now you can APPLY the split chord pattern to all the chords. In the chorus there is an additional C major chord. Try to sing along as you follow the chord progression. Notice that some chords are only played for one bar



PEDAL over each chord change Etc

Alas my love, you do me wrong, to cast me off so discourteously

9

for I have loved you so long, delighting in your com—pa—ny

17

Green—sleeves was all my joy, Green—sleeves was my delight,

25

Green—sleeves was my heart of gold, and who but my lady Green—sleeves.

You can use the sheet music or you can just try to play the tune 'by ear' (a bit of trial and error :-). Very often the melody uses notes from the chord you are playing in the left hand.

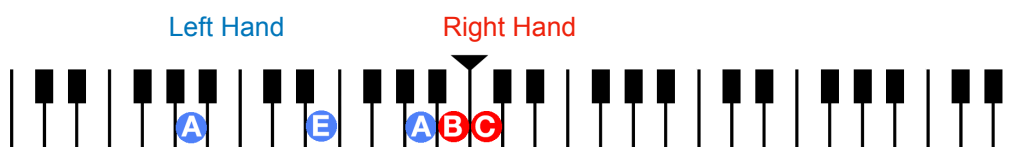
Practice HANDS SEPARATELY first.

© Robin Hall 2021

Greensleeves 1-5-123 pattern with MELODY

You can also try adding the melody over the 1-5-123 pattern.

Instead of playing the pattern with BOTH HANDS as you did earlier.



You play the pattern with the **LEFT HAND ONLY** (watch the video!).

*Keep in mind that Greensleeves is in 3/4 time (3 beats to the bar)
so you are only going to run UP the pattern (not up and down)
and you count "1 and 2 and 3 and" - the highest note is held for '3 and'.*

	COUNT	1	and	2	and	3	and
Am		A	E	A	B	C	
	FINGERING	5	2	1	3	2	
G		G	D	G	A	B	
		5	2	1	3	2	
F		F	C	F	G	A	
		5	2	1	3	2	
E		E	B	E	F#	G#	
		5	2	1	3	2	
C		C	G	C	D	E	
		5	2	1	3	2	

You can then try the melody in the right hand over this left hand pattern.

It's not easy but give it a try and practice it every now and then and you will get better at it.

Greensleeves 1-5-123 pattern with MELODY

PEDAL over each chord change

The musical score is written in 3/4 time and consists of four systems, each containing 8 measures. The melody is in the right hand, and the bass line is in the left hand. The bass line features a continuous eighth-note pattern (pedal) over each chord change. The chords are indicated by letters (A, C, D, E, F, G) and fingerings are shown with numbers (1-5). The score is divided into four systems, each with 8 measures.

System 1 (Measures 1-8):

- Measures 1-4: Chords A, C, D, E. Melody: A (1), C (2), D (3), E (4). Bass: A (1), C (2), D (3), E (4).
- Measures 5-8: Chords F, E, D, B. Melody: F (5), E (4), D (3), B (2). Bass: F (1), E (2), D (3), B (4).

System 2 (Measures 9-16):

- Measures 9-12: Chords G, A, B, C. Melody: G (1), A (2), B (3), C (4). Bass: G (1), A (2), B (3), C (4).
- Measures 13-16: Chords A, A, G#, A, B. Melody: A (2), A (3), G# (2), A (3), B (4). Bass: A (1), A (2), G# (3), A (4), B (5).

System 3 (Measures 17-24):

- Measures 17-20: Chords G, G, F, E, D. Melody: G (3), G (3), F (2), E (1), D (4). Bass: G (1), G (2), F (3), E (4), D (5).
- Measures 21-24: Chords B, G, A, B, C. Melody: B (2), G (1), A (2), B (3), C (4). Bass: B (1), G (2), A (3), B (4), C (5).

System 4 (Measures 25-32):

- Measures 25-28: Chords A, A, G#, A, B. Melody: A (2), A (3), G# (2), A (3), B (4). Bass: A (1), A (2), G# (3), A (4), B (5).
- Measures 29-32: Chords G#, E, A. Melody: G# (2), E (1), A (1). Bass: G# (1), E (2), A (3).

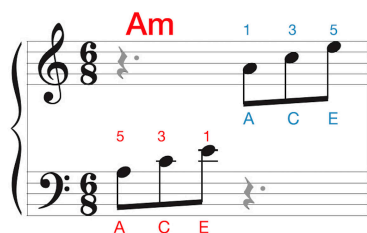
If you struggle with the melody just improvise a tune over the left hand pattern. Just one or two notes in the right hand for each chord change.

You can stick to chord tones to begin with.

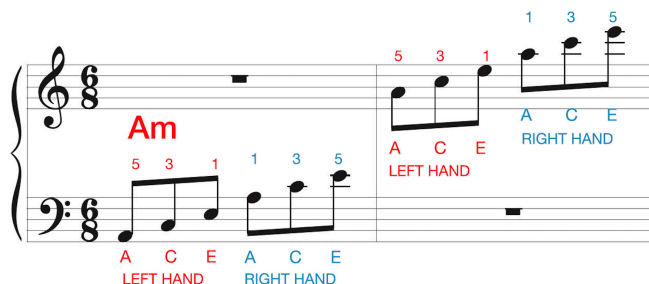
Don't worry about making mistakes - just play around with it for a while.

You can have fun switching between the various rhythmic patterns as you play the song. Here's a recap of all the rhythms.

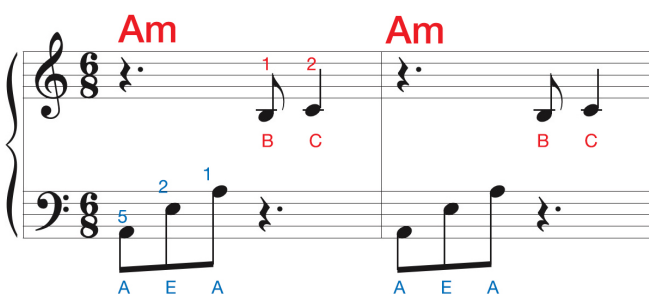
1. Broken Chords Pattern #1
(2 Octaves)



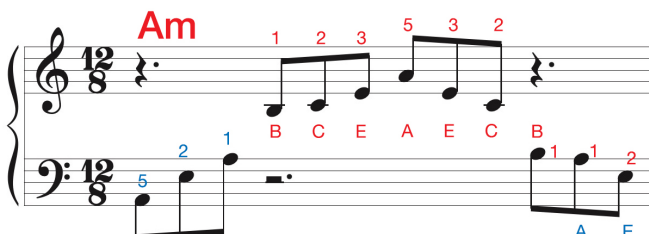
2. Broken Chords Pattern #2
(2 Octaves)



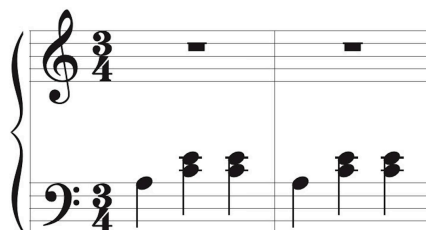
3. 1-5-123 pattern



4. 1-5-123-5-1 pattern



5. Split Chord pattern



6. 1-5-123 pattern
with Melody on top



It's Only The Fairytale

The split chord rhythm you just learned for Greensleeves works really well for a simple yet very beautiful tune called 'It's Only The Fairytale' by Yuki Kajiura from an anime series Mai Hime.

You can listen to the tune on YouTube.

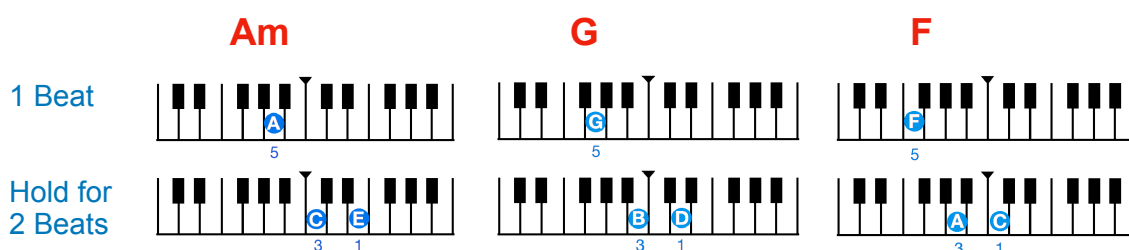
search for 'Mai-Hime OST - It's only the Fairy Tale Piano Cover'.

The great thing is for much of the tune you only need three chords **Am, G, F**

For copyright reasons I can't teach you the melody but I can give you the chord progression and you can listen to the tune on YouTube and easily work it out using a variation of the split chord pattern you used for Greensleeves.

This time you don't even have to play three separate beats.

Play the lower note for 1 beat then the upper two notes together for 2 beats.



PEDAL over each chord change

Am Am G G F G Am Am

COUNT "1 (2 3) 1 (2 3) 1 (2 3) 1 (2 3) 1 (2 3) 1 (2 3) 1 (2 3) 1 (2 3)"

It's Only The Fairytale

Chord Progression for the 1st section

Improvise a melody line in the RIGHT HAND over this left hand chord pattern.

PEDAL over each chord change

Measures 1-8 of the chord progression. The right hand (treble clef) is empty. The left hand (bass clef) plays a steady eighth-note bass line. Chords are indicated in red above the staff: Am, Am, G, G, F, G, Am, Am.

Measures 9-16 of the chord progression. The right hand (treble clef) is empty. The left hand (bass clef) plays a steady eighth-note bass line. Chords are indicated in red above the staff: Am, Am, G, G, F, G, Am, Am.

Measures 17-24 of the chord progression. The right hand (treble clef) is empty. The left hand (bass clef) plays a steady eighth-note bass line. Chords are indicated in red above the staff: F, G, Am, Am, F, G, Am, Am.

Measures 25-32 of the chord progression. The right hand (treble clef) is empty. The left hand (bass clef) plays a steady eighth-note bass line. Chords are indicated in red above the staff: F, G, Am, Am, F, G, Am, Am. The section ends with a double bar line.

YOU ARE NOW READY
FOR

Book 1

RHYTHM
STYLE



Part 5